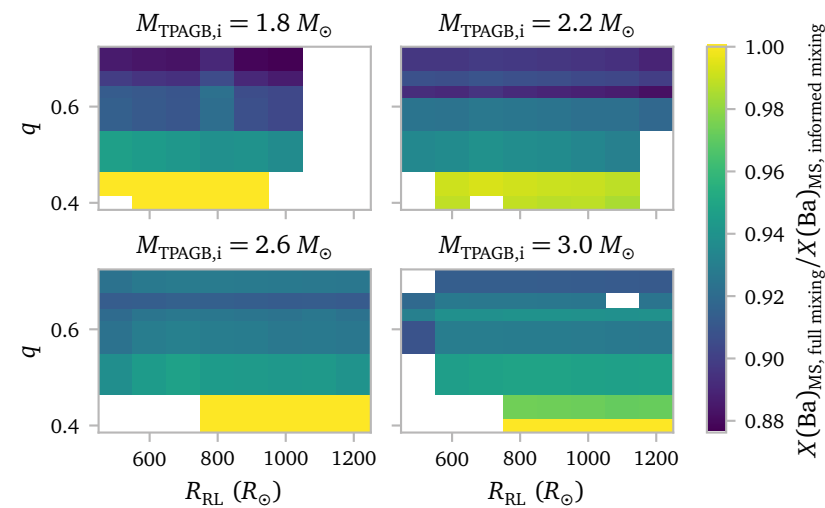


Notes Week 30

a. Checking differences between mixing methods

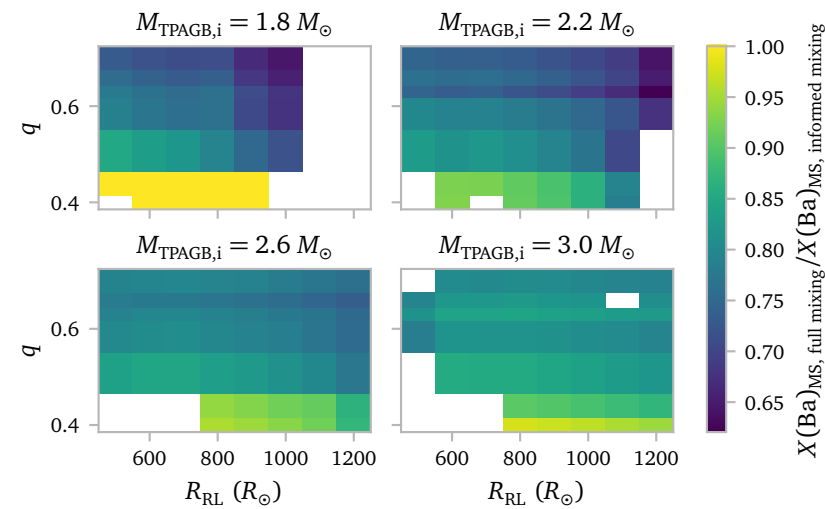
Last week, I showed *this* plot



We would expect larger differences if we have a significant accretor core that is not mixed. Let me investigate.

I quite quickly found the issue, which actually changes the results for every plot I showed last week that was related to the binary abundance post-processing.

I accidentally took the final accretor mass $M_{\text{acc},f}$ as the total amount of accreted mass, while this *obviously* should be $\Delta M_{\text{acc}} = M_{\text{acc},f} - M_{\text{acc},i}$. This is an easy fix and now the plot above looks like this:



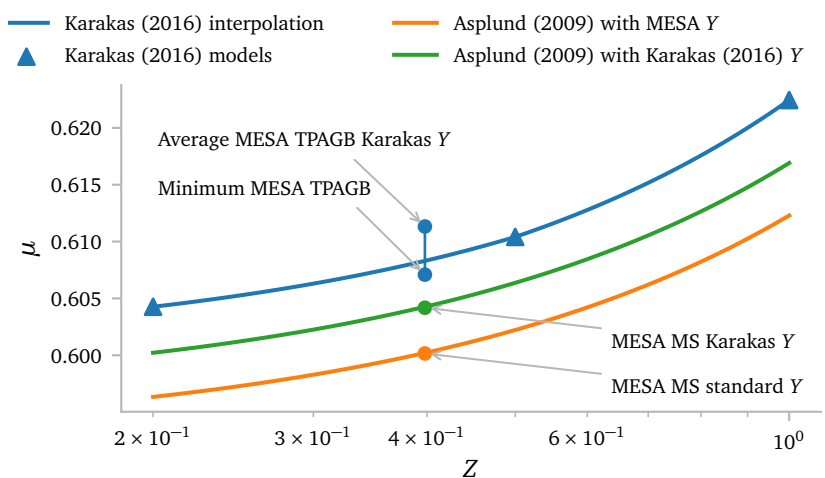
b. Mean Molecular weight MESA vs Monash

We saw that there is a difference between the mean molecular weight of the MESA models and the initial mean molecular weight of the Monash models.

I want to understand where these differences come from.

Let me start by computing μ from the [Asplund et al. \(2009\)](#) solar abundances for the MESA initial Helium mass-fraction.

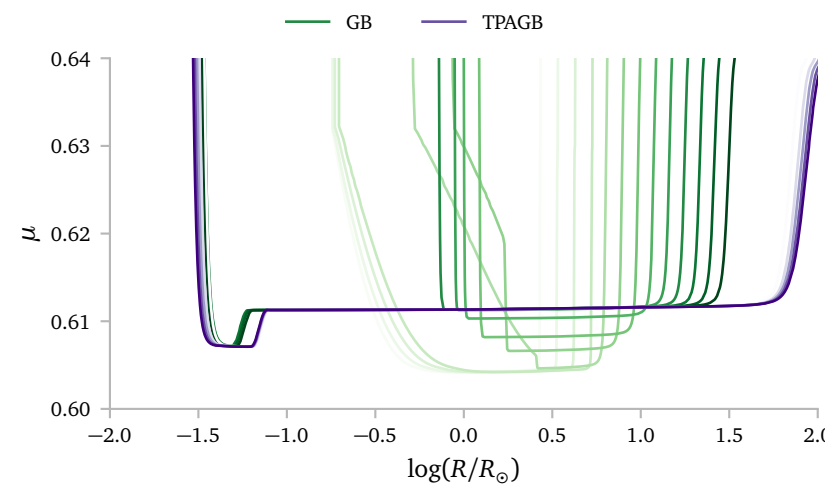
Then I will modify my [Asplund et al. \(2009\)](#) abundances to the “canonical” helium mass-fraction as explained in [Karakas \(2014\)](#).



The mean molecular weights of the MESA models on the main sequence agree very well with the mean molecular weights of the [Asplund et al. \(2009\)](#) for both the standard MESA initial helium mass-fraction as well as the “canonical” [Karakas \(2014\)](#) mass-fraction.

The MESA models do not however, agree that well with the [Karakas & Lugaro \(2016\)](#) mean molecular weights.

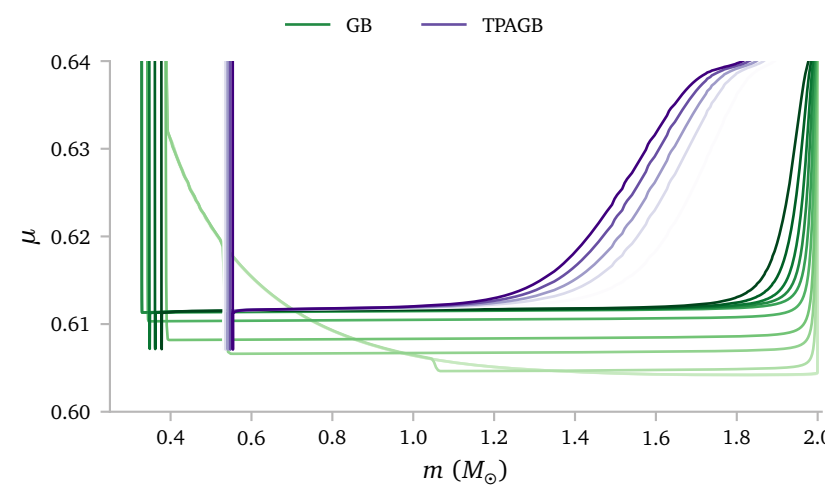
I plotted *two* values for the initial TPAGB MESA model. Below, I show some profiles during the evolution of the MESA model with the [Karakas \(2014\)](#) helium mass-fraction.



There is a little dip just past the helium core boundary. The bottom blue dot in the plot above is sampled from this dip. The upper blue dot is sampled at $R = 1$, which is the value of most of the envelope, and probably the most relevant parameter.

The dip first forms towards the end of the GB already. This is *after* the first dredge-up.

We can obviously also plot it with mass on the horizontal axis. Then it becomes very clear that the small dip is not the relevant value to use.



The minimum is barely visible here. We can also clearly see the growth of the core between the GB and the TPAGB.

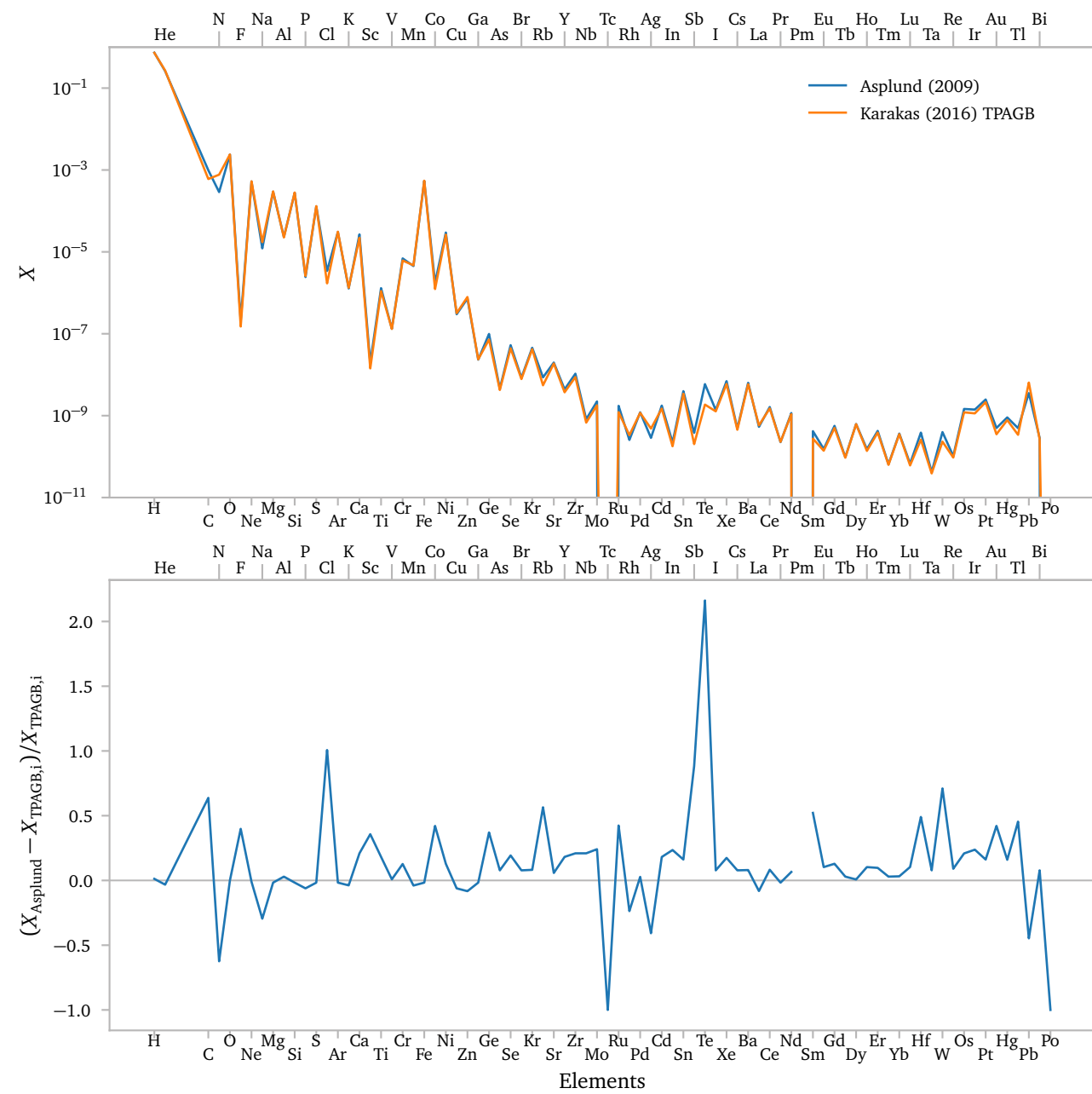
I feel like the best thing to do would be to simulate everything with the [Karakas \(2014\)](#) initial helium mass fraction. This would however mean that I would need to simulate the single stars again, which takes some time and manual help.

An easy first thing to do though is to simulate the accretors with the [Karakas \(2014\)](#) initial helium abundances.

This would at least ensure that the mean molecular weight profile of the main sequence stars should align with the mean molecular weight of the Monash models.

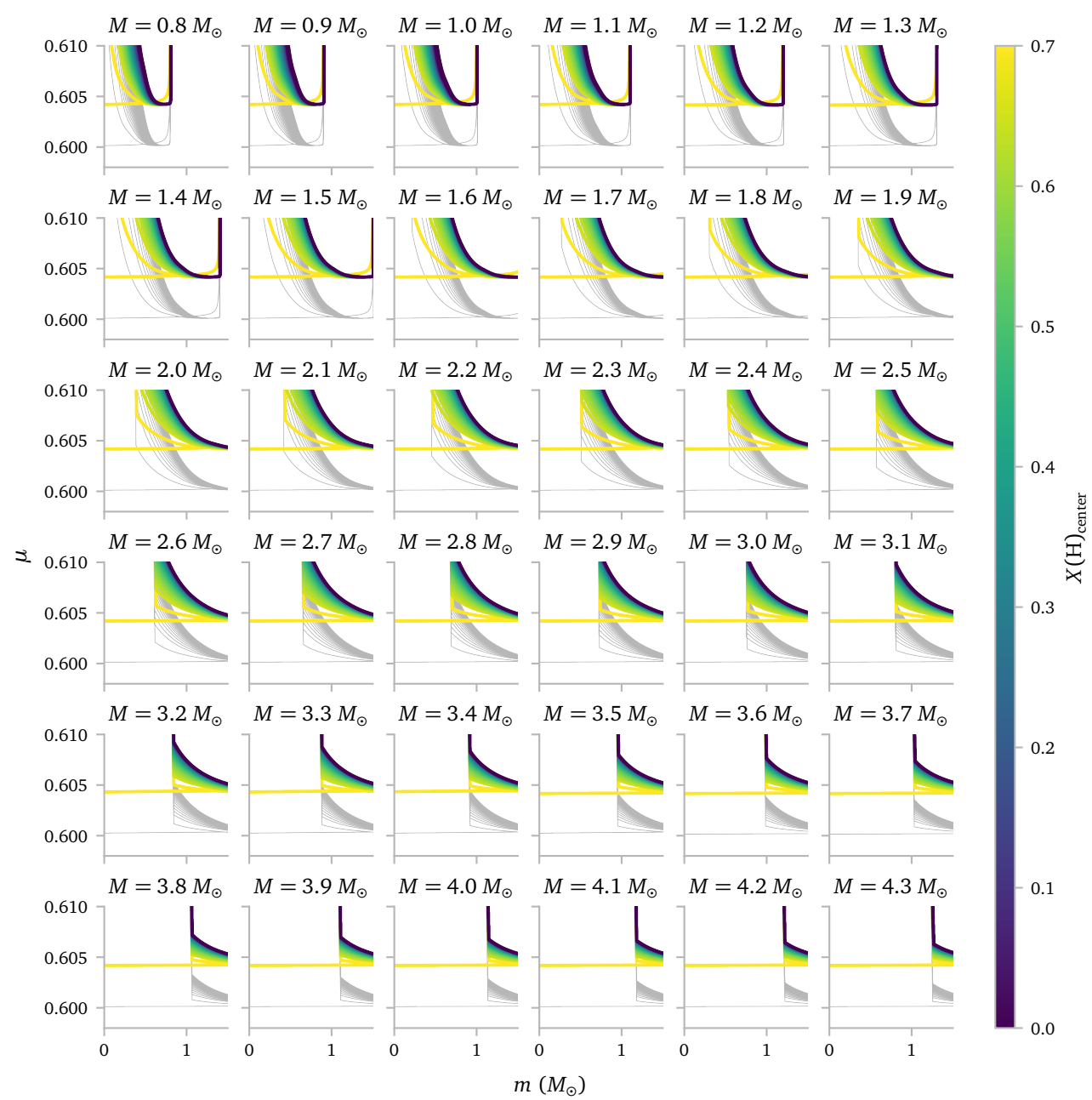
However, the actual MESA binary models would still evolve with a different helium mass fraction. I also think I should use the [Asplund et al. \(2009\)](#) MS abundances for the accretor *instead of*, what I do not, use the initial envelope abundances of the TPAGB stars.

This is quite easy.

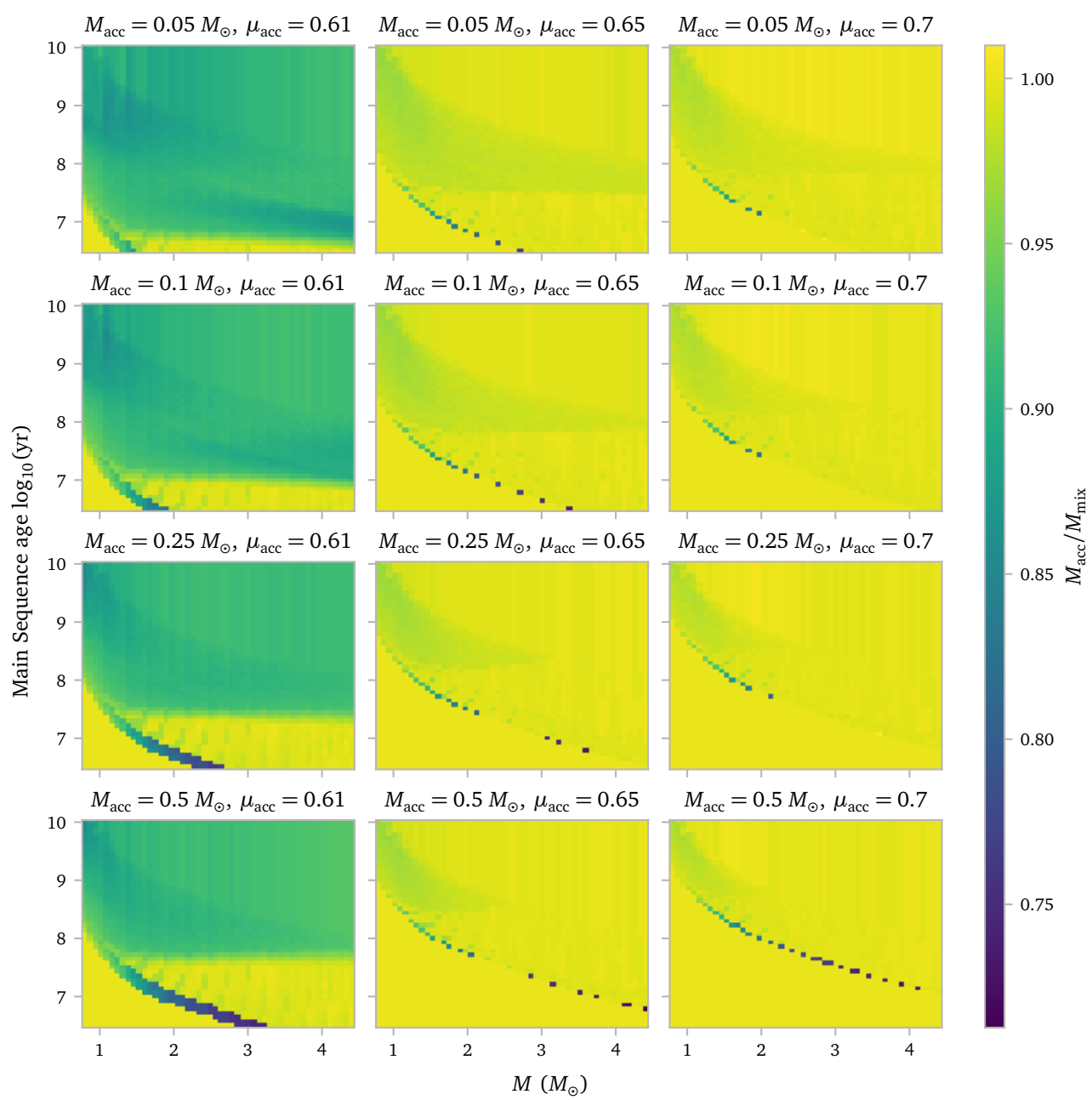


I simulated the main sequence stars with the canonical helium fractions from Karakas (2014).

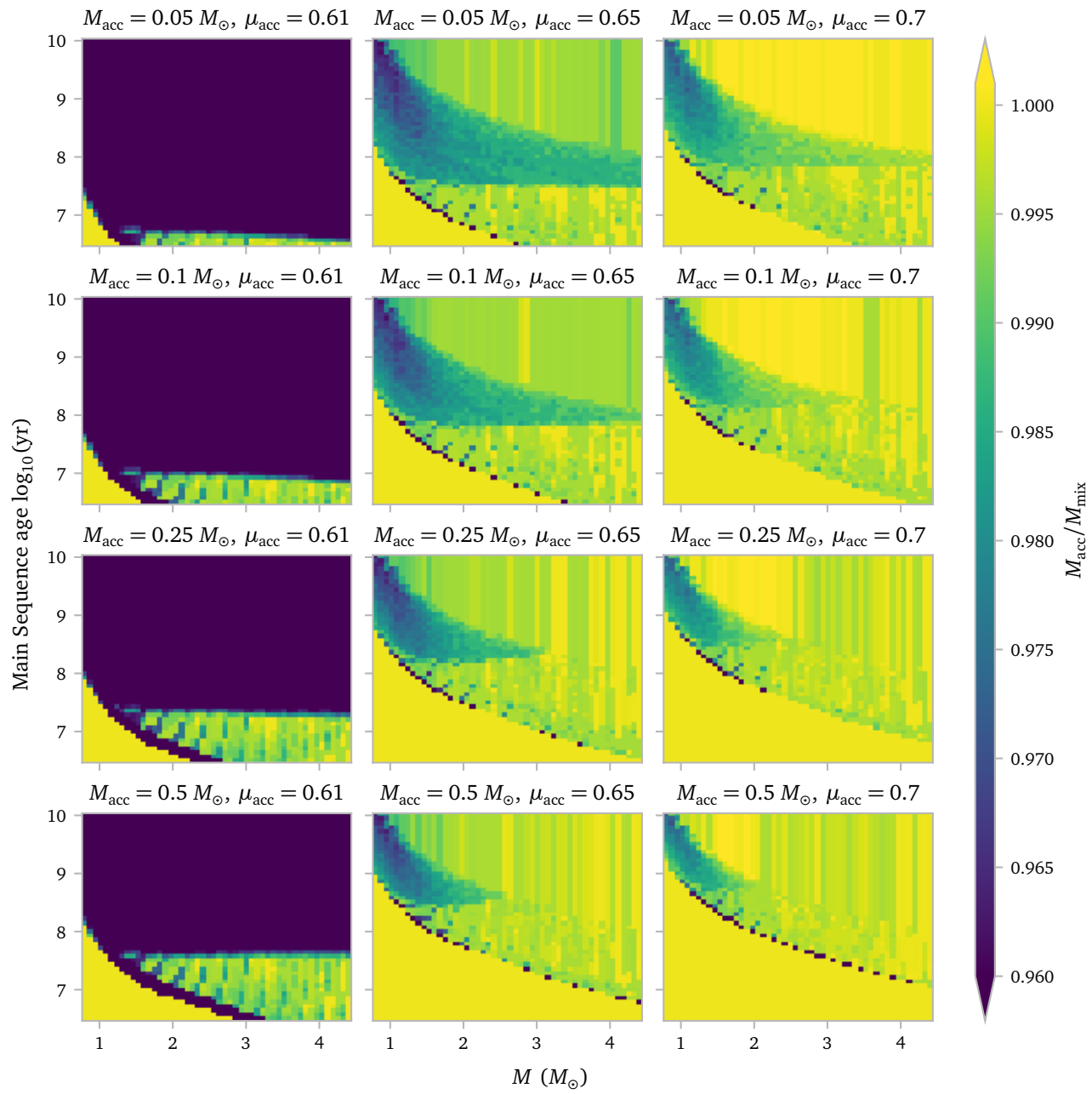
Here is the zoom on the mean molecular weight of the MESA helium mass fractions in gray, and the new ones in color.



The envelope has slightly larger mean molecular weight values. This *should* mean we get slightly lower mixing masses.

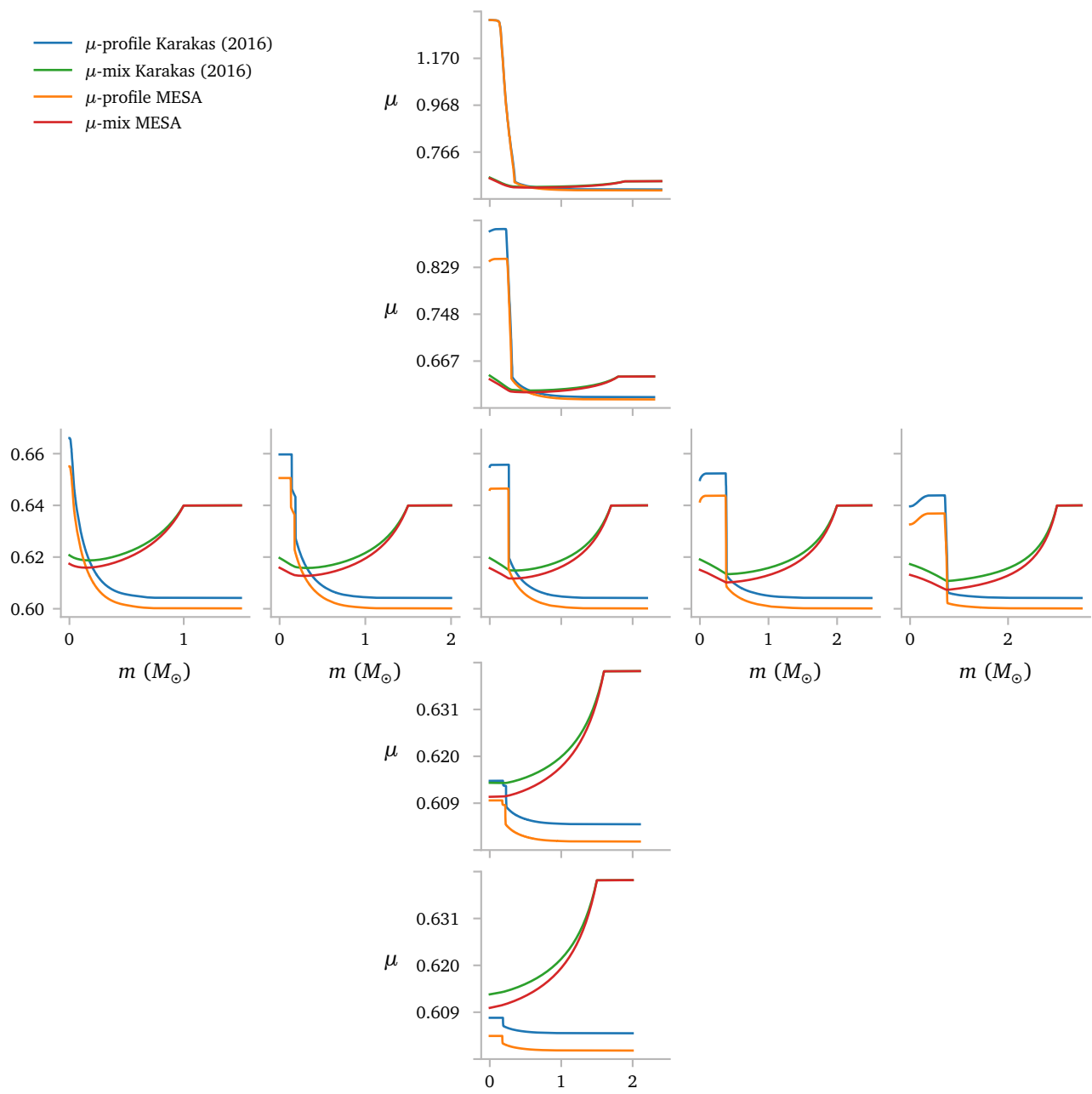
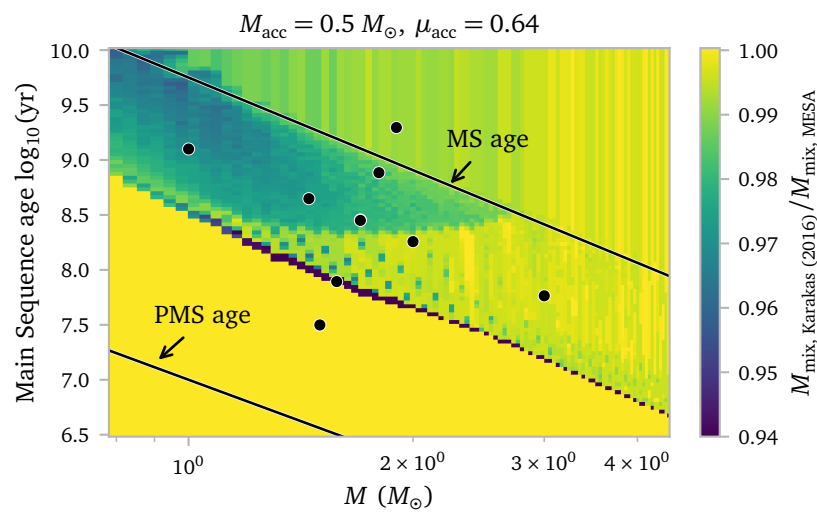


This is indeed what we see. It is much clearer for the second and third column if we zoom in the colors a bit.



However, we also see that only certain regions are affected.

Below, I zoom in on a particular case of M_{acc} and μ_{acc} . I also plot the approximate ages for the pre-MS and the MS. Lastly, I



References

Asplund, M., Grevesse, N., Sauval, A. J., & Scott, P. (2009) *The Chemical Composition of the Sun*. *ARA&A*47, 481.

Karakas, A. I. (2014) *Helium enrichment and carbon-star production in metal-rich populations*. *MNRAS*445, 347.

Karakas, A. I. & Lugaro, M. (2016) *Stellar Yields from Metal-rich Asymptotic Giant Branch Models*. *ApJ*825, 26.